

	A	B	C	D	E
1	SPANISH	LITERAL ENGLISH	FAITHFUL ENGLISH	CULTURAL CONTEXT	TRANSLATION CLARIFICATION
2	Soberanamente espléndido baja el sol hacia el ocaso,	Supremely splendid descends the sun toward the sunset,	The sun, supremely splendid, descends toward the horizon,	Mexican folklore often describes natural scenes with grandeur; the sunset symbolizes not only day ending but cycles of time and renewal.	Literal retains poetic grandeur; faithful rephrases for smoothness and clarity.
3	y ya su gran silueta roja de oro en fusión, va cortando las crestas de las montañas occidentales de las sierras,	and already its great silhouette, red of molten gold, cuts the crests of the western mountains of the sierras,	and its great silhouette, glowing red like molten gold, slices through the peaks of the western mountains,	The sun's descent and golden color signify power and divinity in Mesoamerican belief systems.	Literal is awkward; faithful shifts to natural English without losing metaphor.
4	cubriendo el valle bajo una inmensa atmósfera de intensas fulguraciones metálicas en un vivísimo florecimiento de luz.	covering the valley beneath an immense atmosphere of intense metallic gleams in a vivid blossoming of light.	covering the valley with a vast atmosphere shimmering with intense metallic flashes in a vivid bloom of light.	Light and metallic flashes evoke cosmic and divine presence, not just natural phenomena.	Faithful version replaces heavy literal structure with evocative natural imagery.
5	La tarde iba recostándose lentamente en el lecho almenado de los montes lejanos,	The afternoon was slowly reclining on the crenellated bed of the distant mountains,	The afternoon slowly settled upon the battlemented bed of distant mountains,	Mountains are sacred spaces in Mexican cosmology, here depicted as beds for resting gods or time.	Faithful translation uses 'settled' to soften 'reclining' into natural narrative form.
6	y por el ambiente luminoso corrían ráfagas de claridades violáceas	and through the luminous atmosphere ran gusts of violet clarities	and gusts of violet light swept through the radiant sky	Violet hues often symbolize twilight and transition between worlds (day to night, material to spiritual).	'Violet clarities' is strange in English; faithful uses 'gusts of violet light' for clarity.
7	envolviendo la ciudad imperial con un manto digno de la opulencia de sus mil alcázares.	enveloping the imperial city with a mantle worthy of the opulence of its thousand palaces.	wrapping the imperial city in a mantle worthy of its thousand splendid palaces.	Imperial city and palaces allude to colonial and pre-colonial centers of power and beauty.	'Mantle worthy' keeps metaphor but faithful simplifies palace reference for modern readers.
8	Y por el cielo manchado con nubes de fuego y carmín,	And through the sky stained with clouds of fire and carmine,	And across the sky, streaked with clouds of fire and crimson,	Fire and crimson clouds reflect dramatic storytelling motifs typical in legends, signaling passion or transformation.	'Streaked' better expresses poetic sky description; faithful adjusts 'stained' to fit English poetic usage.
9	sobre acero y...	over steel and...	over steel and...	To be completed on next page...	Fragmentary — will clarify when next portion is available.
10	azulamientos de pavón finísimo, pasaban las flechas radiosas de la aurora vespertina, formando la diadema fúlgida de los volcanes del Oriente.	blueness of fine peacock, passed the radiant arrows of the evening dawn, forming the fleeting diadem of the volcanoes of the East.	delicate peacock blues mingled as radiant arrows of sunset formed a fleeting diadem above the eastern volcanoes.	The volcanoes are poetically described as crowned in colors at sunset, blending Mesoamerican reverence for nature and beauty.	Literal awkwardly retains Spanish word order; faithful clarifies with natural poetic English.
11	¡Gloria póstuma de la majestad de los cíclopes!	Posthumous glory of the majesty of the cyclopes!	Posthumous glory of the mighty cyclopes!	Cyclopes likely refer metaphorically to the giant volcanoes (Popocatepetl and Ixtaccíhuatl).	'Majesty of the cyclopes' changed to 'mighty cyclopes' for natural phrasing.
12	¡Ostentaban corona de fuego y de oro fulmínico Popocatepetl e Ixtaccíhuatl!	They displayed a crown of fire and fulminating gold, Popocatepetl and Ixtaccíhuatl!	Popocatepetl and Ixtaccíhuatl displayed crowns of blazing fire and gold!	The volcanic peaks are personified as rulers crowned at sunset.	Slight reordering for clarity and emphasis.
13	¡Y era soberanamente bello y lujoso aquel crepúsculo!	And supremely beautiful and luxurious was that twilight!	And that twilight was supremely beautiful and magnificent!	Twilight as a majestic moment reflects poetic imagery of endings and transformations.	'Luxurious' softened to 'magnificent' to better suit twilight in English.
14	Y aquel crepúsculo soberano y espléndido con toda la gloria del oro, del fuego, de la luz y de los himnos que a la naturaleza arrancaba,	And that sovereign and splendid twilight with all the glory of gold, of fire, of light, and of the hymns that nature drew forth,	And that magnificent twilight, glowing with gold, fire, and light, echoed with the hymns of nature,	Elaborate personification of nature as singing in the twilight.	Simplified for readability without losing imagery.
15	era el dosel de la gran Tenochtitlán la ciudad imperial, entonces dominadora de reinos vastos y de millares de señoríos.	was the canopy of great Tenochtitlán the imperial city, then ruler of vast kingdoms and thousands of lordships.	served as the canopy above great Tenochtitlán, the imperial city ruling vast realms and countless lordships.	Tenochtitlán is highlighted as the imperial heart of pre-Hispanic Mexico.	More natural phrasing ('served as the canopy' instead of 'was').

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16	Hacía tiempo que los ejércitos acababan de llegar de lejanas regiones cargados con los despojos de los pueblos vencidos	Long ago the armies had just arrived from distant regions laden with the spoils of the vanquished peoples	It had been some time since the armies returned from distant lands, burdened with the spoils of defeated peoples	Refers to Aztec military conquests and tribute system.	Smoothed tense and syntax for narrative clarity.
17	cuyos vencidos fustigando millares de prisioneros, cuya sangre había empapado diariamente las Piedras de los Sacrificios en el Teocalli de Huitzilopochtli.	whose defeated, whipping thousands of prisoners, whose blood daily soaked the Stones of Sacrifice in the Teocalli of Huitzilopochtli.	whose captives, thousands of them, had been whipped and sacrificed daily, their blood staining the Stones of Sacrifice in the temple of Huitzilopochtli.	Evokes the religious rituals and brutality of Aztec human sacrifice.	Rearranged for clarity and smoother description.
18	Imperaba Moctezuma, el rey taciturno, el de los ojos tristes y sombríos,	Ruled Moctezuma, the taciturn king, he of sad and shadowy eyes,	Moctezuma ruled, the silent king with sad and shadowy eyes,	Depicts the melancholy of Moctezuma II on the eve of conquest.	Rephrased for smoother narrative.
19	y de la frente velada por nublazones de tedio;	and of the forehead veiled by clouds of tedium;	and with a brow veiled in clouds of weariness;	Symbolic of Moctezuma's burden and worries.	'Tedium' made more natural as 'weariness.'
20	el monarca de los fantásticos sueños, terror de su corte, Satán de su pueblo.	the monarch of fantastic dreams, terror of his court, Satan of his people.	the monarch of strange dreams, feared by his court, reviled as Satan by his people.	Suggests decline and fear of his tyrannical rule.	Adjusted for tone and clarity.
21	¡Arden, arden!	Burn, burn!	Burn! Burn!	Dramatic exclamation showing visual intensity.	Same literal and faithful due to simplicity.
22	¡Se incendián, parecen formados por licor de oro!	They are burning, they seem formed by liquor of gold!	They burn, glowing as if formed from liquid gold!	Poetic metaphor of volcanoes glowing at dawn/dusk.	Adjusted 'liquor' to 'liquid' to match English usage.
23	parece que el gran Tlague Nahuague los besa para que sean maravillosos	it seems that the great Tlague Nahuague kisses them so that they may be marvelous	it seems the great Tlague Nahuague kisses them to make them marvelous	Tlague Nahuague refers to a divine or mythic figure connected to volcanoes/sun.	Simplified for clarity.
24	—y eso para que yo los mire, para que yo me delecte mirándolos!	—and that so that I may look at them, so that I may delight in looking at them!	—so that I may gaze at them and delight in their beauty!	Emphasizes personal awe and emotional response.	Smoother phrasing.
25	Gritó el emperador, en transporte de orgullo,	Shouted the emperor, in transport of pride,	The emperor cried out, filled with pride,	Shows emotional intensity.	Adjusted for smoother English.
26	al ver hecha en el ambiente del valle la apoteosis de los dos volcanes y los últimos rayos del sol.	seeing made in the valley's air the apotheosis of the two volcanoes and the last rays of the sun.	as he saw in the valley air the apotheosis of the two volcanoes lit by the sun's last rays.	The scene peaks with majestic personification of the volcanoes.	Clarified word order.
27	¡Hallabase el rey azteca en la terraza más alta de su palacio favorito, solitario y absorto en la contemplación melancólica de los radiosos horizontes con que la naturaleza le brindaba desvaneciendo el regío hastío de sus horas muertas!	The Aztec king was on the highest terrace of his favorite palace, solitary and absorbed in the melancholic contemplation of the radiant horizons with which nature offered him, dispelling the regal boredom of his dead hours!	The Aztec king stood alone on the highest terrace of his favorite palace, lost in melancholic contemplation of the radiant horizons nature offered, easing the regal weariness of his idle hours.	The king's isolation reflects both imperial majesty and existential melancholy before coming change.	Regal and poetic phrasing made smoother for narrative clarity.
28	¡Y bien lo necesitaba el pobre emperador!	And well did the poor emperor need it!	And the poor emperor truly needed it!	Expression of empathy and humanization of the ruler.	Faithful version emphasizes pathos more naturally.
29	Hacía tiempo que sufría hondas nostalgias, y también resonaban aún en sus oídos en cruellísimas noches de pesadillas,	For a long time he had suffered deep nostalgia, and cruel prophecies still echoed in his ears during terrible nights of nightmares,	He had long been burdened by deep sorrow, and cruel prophecies still haunted him on nightmare-filled nights,	Highlights the ever-present fear of prophecy and downfall common in Mesoamerican lore.	Condensed for readability and narrative flow.

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30	las funestas profecías de los ancianos sacerdotes que le habían hablado de tremendos cataclismos, que deberían transformar para siempre la faz de su imperio,	the ominous prophecies of the ancient priests who had spoken to him of tremendous cataclysms that would forever transform the face of his empire,	warnings from ancient priests of terrible cataclysms destined to forever change the face of his empire,	Priestly warnings of divine or cosmic upheaval align with Mesoamerican apocalyptic thinking.	Clarified ominous prophecies and destiny.
31	del que sus hijos, desdichados príncipes desterrados, arrebatados de su gloria y prestigio, quienes habían de contemplar sus días también arrojados de sus templos.	from which his sons, unhappy exiled princes, stripped of their glory and prestige, who would see their days also thrown from their temples.	where his sons, unhappy exiled princes stripped of their glory, would also be cast from their temples.	Depicts political and familial tragedy, loss of power and exile.	Simplified and ordered for natural narrative.
32	¡Oh! sí, mucho tiempo hacía que el infeliz Moctezuma paseábase, siniestro y lúgubre, por la terraza de su palacio favorito;	Oh yes, it had been long since the unhappy Moctezuma wandered, sinister and gloomy, through the terrace of his favorite palace;	Oh yes, for a long time the unhappy Moctezuma had wandered, grim and gloomy, along the terrace of his palace;	Moctezuma portrayed as tragic and heavy with sorrow, symbolic of fate.	Made more fluid in English.
33	pero al caer el crepúsculo de aquella tarde, sintiose estremecido por súbita llamarada de orgullo,	but at dusk that day, he felt shaken by a sudden flame of pride,	but as dusk fell that day, he was suddenly stirred by a flash of pride,	The momentary pride contrasts his deep sorrow — grandeur amidst decline.	Shifted to active voice and clearer phrasing.
34	contemplando la lluvia de fuego y oro que sobre los dos gigantes cíclopes inmóviles de Oriente caía en una apotheosis de soberana grandeza.	contemplating the rain of fire and gold falling on the two giant immobile cyclopes of the East in an apotheosis of sovereign grandeur.	watching the rain of fire and gold fall upon the two great motionless cyclopes of the East in a majestic apotheosis.	The volcanoes again personified, linking natural spectacle to imperial majesty.	Clarified metaphoric language.
35	Algunas horas habían transcurrido.	Some hours had passed.	Some hours had passed.	Transition scene marking passage of time and calm before drama.	Simple sentence, direct translation.
36	Ya la noche —una divina, serena, plácida noche de cristal purísima, cual de plata fina y reluciente, caía tranquila, apacible, infinita sobre la gran Tenochtitlan.	And now the night — a divine, serene, placid night of purest crystal, like fine and shining silver, fell calmly, peacefully, infinitely over great Tenochtitlán.	Night had come — divine, serene, a peaceful night of pure crystal, like radiant silver, falling softly and infinitely over great Tenochtitlán.	Night described in ethereal, poetic terms reinforces cosmic beauty and order.	Smoothed poetic description.
37	Reverberaban a sus rayos argentarios todas las resplandecientes blancuras de los palacios;	All the resplendent whiteness of the palaces gleamed in the silvery rays;	The radiant whiteness of the palaces shimmered under the silvery moonlight;	Palaces shining under moonlight evokes both beauty and power of the imperial city.	Clarified 'resplendent whiteness' into shimmering moonlight.
38	las torres de los teocallis se alzaban en el terciopelo azul oscuro de los cielos.	the towers of the teocallis rose into the dark blue velvet of the skies.	and the towers of the teocallis rose into the dark, velvet-blue heavens.	Teocallis (temples) symbolically reaching toward the divine sky.	Smoothed phrase for poetic clarity.
39	Y el redondo disco de la luna, pálido y triste, era un resplandor mágico prendido ante las majestades lejanas del Popocatepetl y Ixtaccihuatl.	And the round disk of the moon, pale and sad, was a magical glow hanging before the distant majesties of Popocatepetl and Ixtaccihuatl.	And the full moon, pale and sorrowful, cast a magical glow before the distant majesties of Popocatepetl and Ixtaccihuatl.	The moon is personified and symbolizes sadness and reflection, common in poetic depictions of nature.	Literal phrasing adjusted for natural poetic English.
40	¡Y no eran oro en fusión sus cabezas de inmóviles gigantes; eran luz blanquísima refulgiendo en los espacios azules!	And their heads were not molten gold; they were very white light shining in the blue spaces!	And their peaks were not molten gold but pure white light gleaming across the blue heavens!	Volcano peaks depicted as majestic yet cold, representing both beauty and death.	Clarified metaphor into poetic description of peaks.
41	Y aún más taciturno, más sombrío, Moctezuma los contemplaba.	And still more taciturn, more somber, Moctezuma contemplated them.	Growing even more silent and somber, Moctezuma watched them.	Moctezuma's deepening gloom reflects the inevitability of fate.	Naturalized description for smooth reading.

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42	"Están helados, están muertos, son nieve y plata —	"They are frozen, they are dead, they are snow and silver —	"They are frozen, they are dead, they are snow and silver —	Metaphor of death and isolation heightens the dramatic tension.	Kept dramatic lament intact.
43	Sus coronas son inmensas perlas blancas irisadas de azul, emblema de las tranquilidades frías de la tumba, de la claridad eternamente glacial de la muerte!"	Their crowns are immense white pearls iridescent with blue, emblem of the cold tranquility of the tomb, of the eternally glacial clarity of death!"	Their crowns are vast white pearls shimmering with blue, symbols of the tomb's cold tranquility,	Pearls and iridescence symbolize otherworldly and eternal qualities.	Rephrased for poetic and clear symbolism.
44			of death's eternally icy clarity!"	Death as cold and inevitable — poetic vision of the afterlife.	Clarified and softened for readability.
45	¿Porque no se levantan y vienen a mí, a mí que soy el dueño de los destinos de cien naciones? ¡Oh, volcanes, emperadores de las tierras, venid!"	Why do they not rise and come to me, to me who am the master of the destinies of a hundred nations? Oh, volcanoes, emperors of the lands, come!"	"Why do they not rise and come to me, I who am master of the fates of a hundred nations? Oh volcanoes, emperors of the earth, come to me!"	Moctezuma sees the volcanoes as gods/emperors indifferent to human struggles.	Made plea more fluid in natural English.
46	Infinito silencio caía sobre la gran ciudad imperial;	Infinite silence fell over the great imperial city;	An infinite silence fell over the vast imperial city.	Imperial silence highlights tension and impending doom.	Slightly condensed for narrative flow.
47	el palacio del emperador también hallábase envuelto en la grave paz de la noche —	the emperor's palace too was wrapped in the grave peace of the night —	The emperor's palace too lay still in the heavy peace of night —	Night's quiet amplifies the emotional weight of the scene.	Clarified for natural phrasing.
48	y tan solo de las oscuras lejanías del valle, — trémulos y melancólicos, — llegaban ecos vagos, y tristesísimos, como suspiros,	and only from the dark distances of the valley, — tremulous and melancholic, — came vague and very sad echoes, like sighs,	and only from the valley's dark and distant reaches came faint, sorrowful echoes, like sighs,	Echoes and sighs symbolize ghostly or spiritual presence.	Smoothed poetic description.
49	estremeciendo las brisas frías bajo la claridad dulce y blanca de la luna.	shaking the cold breezes under the soft and white clarity of the moon.	as the cold breeze shivered beneath the moon's gentle and white radiance.	Moonlight adds softness to the scene while cold winds signify sadness.	Simplified into flowing poetic prose.
50	¡Que venga el viejo Paraujojo!" exclamó el emperador.	"Let old Paraujojo come!" exclaimed the emperor.	"Summon old Paraujojo!" cried the emperor.	Paraujojo seems to be a mythical or wise elder figure — calling him heightens dramatic tension.	Made exclamation clearer.
51	Los guardias que a lo lejos, a la sombra de los muros altos de la terraza velaban al monarca, lanzaron en el gran silencio la orden.	The guards far away, in the shadow of the high terrace walls, kept watch over the monarch and gave the order in the great silence.	The distant guards, in the shadow of the high terrace walls, kept watch and sent the command into the deep silence.	Guards' reaction reflects rigid court protocol and imperial formality.	Clarified guards' action.
52	Los gritos fueron repercutiendo en las profundidades del palacio.	The cries echoed through the depths of the palace.	The calls echoed through the palace's depths.	Echoing cries emphasize loneliness and vast emptiness of the palace.	Clarified and simplified the palace's echoing silence.
53	Noble anciano, sumo sacerdote — Atalaya del Universo, prisionero traído de la inmensa ciudad santa de Mitla, — tembloroso por la verdad, llega ante Moctezuma el taciturno, mirándole con soberbia y majestuosa fijeza que hace bajar los ojos del orgulloso rey mexicano.	Noble elder, high priest — Watchtower of the Universe, prisoner brought from the immense holy city of Mitla — trembling with truth, comes before the taciturn Moctezuma, looking at him with haughty and majestic firmness that makes the proud Mexican king lower his eyes.	Noble elder, high priest — Watchman of the Universe, prisoner brought from the great holy city of Mitla — trembling with truth, came before the somber Moctezuma, whose proud and majestic gaze made even the mighty king lower his eyes.	Introduction of a sacred elder figure from Mitla — linking Zapotec and Mexica cultures.	Clarified and smoothed phrasing while retaining formality.

	A	B	C	D	E
54	"Dime, anciano, que descubres tras las frentes de los hombres sus pensamientos, tras los viejos árboles la historia de sus naciones, tras las montañas la vida antigua de la tierra y tras las estrellas lo desconocido de la eternidad,	"Tell me, elder, you who see beyond men's brows into their thoughts, beyond old trees into the history of nations, beyond mountains into the earth's ancient life, and beyond stars into eternity's unknown,	"Tell me, elder, you who read men's thoughts beyond their brows, who see history in ancient trees, life in mountains, and eternity in the stars,	The elder is portrayed as wise and mystical, with vision extending beyond the physical world.	Simplified complex metaphor for clarity.
55	dime, sacerdote zapoteca, ¿por qué en la mañana se visten de oscuro, se diafanizan a mediodía, doranse al crepúsculo y en las noches negras son temibles fantasmas, y coronanse de plata nívea en las apacibles noches de luna?	tell me, Zapotec priest, why in the morning they dress in dark, become transparent at noon, turn golden at twilight, and at night become fearsome ghosts crowned with silvery white in peaceful moonlit nights?	tell me, Zapotec priest, why do they darken in the morning, turn clear at noon, glow gold at twilight, and become fearsome ghosts crowned in silver on peaceful moonlit nights?	Natural phenomena (day phases) are poetically linked to divine or supernatural beings.	Clarified poetic metaphor about phases of day and divine imagery.
56	¿Qué hacen allí tan bellos, terribles y eternos? ¿Qué fueron?	What do they do there, so beautiful, terrible, and eternal? What were they?	Why are they so beautiful, terrible, and eternal? What were they?	Existential questioning about divine beings and their eternal, terrible beauty.	Smoothed and clarified rhetorical questions.
57	Cuenta, cuéntame su historia, sabio sacerdote, — Y volverás a Mitla cargado de ofrendas para tu gran Palacio-Templo-Sepulcro."	Tell me their story, wise priest — and you shall return to Mitla laden with offerings for your great Palace-Temple-Tomb."	Tell me their story, wise priest — and you shall return to Mitla bearing offerings for your great Palace-Temple-Tomb."	Moctezuma shows reverence, seeking ancient wisdom — symbolizing humility before cosmic mysteries.	Clarified Moctezuma's command in natural English.
58	Así respondió el anciano sacerdote:	Thus replied the elder priest:	The elder priest answered:	Transition to elder priest's mythical narrative.	Straightforward narrative transition.
59	"Oye: Cien mil veces el sol ha derramado su gloriosa luz sobre el mundo desde que fue el primer día."	"Listen: A hundred thousand times the sun has shed its glorious light upon the world since the first day."	"Hear me: A hundred thousand times the sun has poured its glorious light upon the world since the first day."	Cosmic time and the sun's cycles introduce the mythic framework.	Slightly smoothed for poetic flow.
60	Tlaque Nahuacque, "Alma de la Vida Universal" — hizo el primer hombre para poblar el jardín de las eternas flores,	Tlaque Nahuacque, "Soul of Universal Life" — made the first man to populate the garden of eternal flowers,	Tlaque Nahuacque, "Soul of Universal Life," made the first man to populate the garden of eternal flowers,	Creation story rooted in Mesoamerican belief of divine creation of humanity.	Clarified creator's role and divine purpose.
61	el huerto, como el hombre, estaba solo, le dio una mujer blanca, hecha de la luz de la luna y nieve fundida, pero sólida, — para él que era todo.	The orchard, like the man, was alone, so he gave him a white woman, made of moonlight and snow, melted yet solid — for him who was all.	The orchard, like the man, stood alone, so he gave him a white woman, made of moonlight and solidified snow — his eternal companion."	Introduction of the first woman from moon and snow — symbolic purity and divine origin.	Clarified poetic description of creation.
62	fuerza, razón, majestad ¡sol! Ella era ternura, delicadeza, melancolía, dulzura, es decir ¡luna!	strength, reason, majesty — sun! She was tenderness, delicacy, melancholy, sweetness — that is to say, moon!	strength, reason, and majesty — sun! She was tenderness, delicacy, melancholy, and sweetness — moon!	Duality of sun and moon as masculine and feminine principles in Mesoamerican cosmology.	Clarified poetic metaphor into more natural description.
63	Se amaron.	They loved each other.	They fell in love.	Emphasis on divine love and harmony.	Simple and direct phrase to convey love.

	A	B	C	D	E
64	¡Ambos eran felices! El gran Huerto de la Vida era su Palacio — eran libres, se amaban — mas he aquí que no debían anhelar descubrir el más allá, no debían ambicionar más goces que los que la vida de su jardín les brindaba, ni debían extender sus paseos fuera del misterioso y perfumado jardín. Ni debían tampoco buscar más placeres que los de la vida.	Both were happy! The great Garden of Life was their Palace — they were free, they loved each other — but they should not have desired to discover the beyond, nor to seek greater pleasures than those their garden offered, nor venture beyond the perfumed and mysterious garden. Nor should they have sought pleasures beyond life itself.	They were happy! The great Garden of Life was their palace — free and loving — yet they were forbidden to seek the beyond, to desire pleasures greater than those life and the garden offered, or to wander beyond its scented, mystical bounds.	Edenic allegory — forbidden knowledge and limitations on human desire.	Smoothed to reflect allegorical Eden-like restriction.
65	Y sucedió que un día, él todo fuerza, voluntad y orgullo, miró tan hermosa a ella, toda delicadeza, dulzura y obediencia, sucedió que él, todo sol, poder, quiso ir a nuevas regiones con ella toda luna, obediencia.	And it happened one day, he, all strength, will, and pride, looked upon her, all delicacy, sweetness, and obedience, and he, all sun and power, desired to go to new regions with her, all moon and obedience.	But one day, he, full of strength, will, and pride, saw her beauty — all delicacy, sweetness, and obedience — and desired to journey with her, moon-like and gentle, to new realms.	Fall narrative — pride and desire lead to tragic fate.	Clarified poetic description for smoother narrative.
66	¡Se amaron! ¡Mas! ¡Ay! el orgullo los perdió — Debieron sujetarse a su destino para ser felices, y se perdieron!	"They loved each other! But alas! Pride destroyed them — they should have accepted their destiny to be happy, but they were lost!	"They loved! But alas! Pride doomed them — had they accepted their fate, they would have remained happy, yet they were lost.	Myth explains separation and eternal yearning — love thwarted by fate.	Retained dramatic lament and warning tone.
67	Una tempestad de rayos, cataratas y sombras los hicieron huir del jardín de paz — y empezaron a caminar por el mundo, los dos, sollozantes y tristes, avergonzados, sembrando por doquier la tierra con sus hijos los que apenas nacían cuando se dispersaban para vivir entre las cavernas, odiándose los unos a los otros;	A storm of lightning, waterfalls, and shadows drove them from the garden of peace — they wandered the earth, both weeping and sad, ashamed, sowing the earth with children,	A tempest of lightning, floods, and shadows drove them from the peaceful garden — they wandered the world, sorrowful and ashamed,	Departure from paradise marks beginning of mortal suffering and human conflict.	Clarified chaotic expulsion and beginning of human strife.
68	y ya grandes, se declaraban la guerra y se exterminaban en crueles batallas — Y el Hombre Sol iba caminando en pos de la Mujer Luna, buscando un valle ameno para reposar eternamente, amándose siempre, aún en su mismo sepulcro.	who, as they grew, scattered to live in caves, hating each other; and as adults, they waged war and destroyed each other in cruel battles — and the Man Sun wandered, seeking the Woman Moon, looking for a gentle valley to rest forever, loving each other still, even in their shared tomb.	and their children, scattered to the caves, turned to hatred and war; grown, they waged cruel battles — and the Man of the Sun, still loving the Woman of the Moon, roamed in search of a peaceful valley to rest with her forever, loving still even in their tomb.	Final mythic motif — eternal quest and love in death; nature allegory for sun and moon's celestial dance.	Clarified eternal search and poetic conclusion.

	A	B	C	D	E
69	Y caminaban atrevesando los desiertos — Él, a veces, en las lúgubres noches profundísimas, cuando las tinieblas caían muy densas del cielo, se inclinaba a la tierra para arrancar algún bosque espeso; lo encendía con dos montañas que hacía chocar, y producía chispa enorme, y así iban alumbrando su camino —	And they wandered through the deserts — He, at times, in the darkest, most mournful nights when thick shadows fell from the sky, bent to the earth to tear up dense forests; he lit them by striking two mountains together, producing great sparks and thus lighting their way —	They journeyed through the deserts — He, at times, during the darkest nights when deep shadows fell, tore dense forests from the earth and lit them by striking mountains together, sparking great flames to light their way —	Deserts symbolize trials and wandering — linked to cosmic and spiritual journeys.	Clarified poetic and mythic phrasing for natural storytelling.
70	Otras veces, ella, blanca, diáfana, incorpórea, levantaba su frente hacia la altura y la luna le enviaba por compasión, algún rayo de plata que se reflejaba en sus cabellos, y por aquel rayo iluminados, seguían su marcha por la tierra, siglos y siglos, "por las inmensas soledades del mundo."	Other times, she, white, diaphanous, incorporeal, raised her brow to the heights and the moon, in compassion, sent down silver rays which reflected in her hair; thus illuminated, they continued their march across the earth, for centuries upon centuries, "through the immense solitudes of the world."	Other times, she, white and ethereal, raised her face to the sky, and the moon, in compassion, sent silver rays that shone in her hair, guiding them for countless ages "through the vast loneliness of the world."	The Moon as a compassionate, guiding force — silver rays as symbols of hope.	Smoothed ethereal metaphor into poetic English.
71	"¡Horroroso castigo!" Exclamó el emperador Moctezuma, consternado, temblando todo el cuerpo.	"Horrible punishment!" cried Emperor Moctezuma, distressed and trembling.	"What a terrible punishment!" cried Emperor Moctezuma, shaken to his core.	Moctezuma's reaction represents mortal horror at divine punishments and fate.	Naturalized dramatic outcry.
72	El anciano sacerdote continuó irguiéndose ante la amilanada figura del monarca México.	The ancient priest stood upright before the fearful monarch of Mexico.	The ancient priest continued, standing firm before the trembling monarch.	The elder priest continues narrating mythic truths — continuity of sacred story.	Simplified for narrative clarity.
73	"Hasta que por fin sucedió que un día llegaron al más hermoso valle que habían visto: Y era el valle de la muerte, de la desolación, del fuego, — y también de la vida, el rejuvenecimiento y la luz.	"Until finally, one day, they reached the most beautiful valley they had ever seen: And it was the valley of death, desolation, fire — and also of life, renewal, and light.	"At last they came upon the most beautiful valley they had seen: the valley of death, desolation, fire — yet also of life, renewal, and light.	Valley as liminal space — between death and life, symbolic of Mesoamerican duality.	Clarified and smoothed contrast of death and renewal.
74	Valle de la Primavera y del Invierno — Porque en un tiempo el fuego súbito de las cóleras de las montañas lo formó —	Valley of Spring and Winter — For once, the sudden fury of the mountains' anger had formed it —	A valley of Spring and Winter — once formed by the violent fury of the mountains —	Violent origins (fire) balanced by later tranquility — creation through destruction.	Clarified mythical and poetic fire origin.
75	pero después en la gran ánfora calcinada y roja — cayeron cristalinas aguas que refrescaron el horror del fuego — y hubo fuentes, flores, amor, en torno de las murallas graníticas refrescadas y engalanadas primaveralmente.	but later, in the great burnt and red amphora — crystal waters fell to cool the horror of fire — and there were fountains, flowers, love, around granite walls refreshed and adorned with spring's beauty.	but later cooled by crystal waters that soothed the land, bringing forth fountains, flowers, and love around granite walls, now refreshed and decked in spring's glory.	Rebirth imagery — cooled fire, blooming nature, and love reflect cyclical worldview.	Simplified to reflect rebirth and love metaphor.
76	El Hombre Sol dijo: "Aquí descansaremos."	The Man of the Sun said: "Here we will rest."	The Man of the Sun said: "Here we shall rest."	Declaration of rest marks mythic end to the sun's quest.	Clarified declaration with poetic tone.

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77	Y agregó la Mujer-Luna — “Esta será mi tumba, porque dentro de ese valle crecerán nuestros hijos y los protegeremos — y nuestras tumbas eternas les harán...”	And the Woman-Moon added: "This will be my tomb, because in this valley our children will grow and we will protect them — and our eternal tombs will..."	And the Woman of the Moon added: "This shall be my tomb, for here our children will grow, and we will protect them — our eternal resting place shall..."	Moon's tomb signifies eternal presence and guardianship — celestial immortality.	Clarified moon's speech and eternal metaphor.
78	pensar para ver el porvenir y para que, previendo, obren bien, y no padezcan, y no se hundan en la noche del infortunio como nosotros."	to think of the future and so that, foreseeing, they may act well, not suffer, nor sink into the night of misfortune like us."	to think of the future and act wisely, to avoid suffering and falling into misfortune like us."	Reflects Mesoamerican wisdom themes — moral lessons for future generations.	Clarified moral teaching and natural phrasing.
79	"¡Oh! ¡Amada mía!" exclamó él.	"Oh! My beloved!" he exclaimed.	"Oh, my beloved!" he cried.	Romantic and mythic invocation of eternal love.	Naturalized emotional exclamation.
80	"Estoy fatigada; déjame descansar, vela mi sueño" — respondió la blanca mujer, recostándose, bellísima, sobre el inmenso lecho, trono de alta montaña.	"I am tired; let me rest, watch over my sleep," replied the white woman, reclining, very beautiful, upon the immense bed, throne of a high mountain.	"I am weary; let me rest, guard my dreams," answered the white woman, gracefully reclining upon the vast bed, throne of a high mountain.	Mythic moment of surrender and passage into timelessness.	Clarified poetic and dreamlike narrative.
81	Y él, solícito, erguido, permaneció ante su amada durmiente — Y cuando el sol surgió tras de ellos, su beso divino los engrandeció, petrificándolos, para todos los siglos, y ejemplo de sus hijos, los hijos del Valle de México.	And he, solicitous, stood upright before his sleeping beloved — And when the sun rose behind them, its divine kiss glorified and petrified them for all time, as an example for their children, the children of the Valley of Mexico.	He stood watch over her as she slept — And when the sun rose behind them, its divine kiss transformed them into stone forever, a symbol for their descendants, the children of the Valley of Mexico.	Petrification reflects mythic motif — transformation into landscape features.	Smoothed to natural English mythic phrasing.
82	La naturaleza es el agua, el fuego, la vida, la muerte — Y es ella la hija vengadora de Tlaque Nahuacque! ¡Óyelo, Emperador! ¡Ay de ti! Prevee, medita, obra!"	"Nature is water, fire, life, and death — And she is the avenging daughter of Tlaque Nahuacque! Hear this, Emperor! Woe to you! Foresee, reflect, act!"	"Nature is water, fire, life, and death — And she is the avenging daughter of Tlaque Nahuacque! Listen, Emperor! Beware! Reflect and act!"	Personification of natural forces and divine retribution in Mesoamerican mythology.	Clarified personified nature and threat warning.
83	El enorme silencio de la noche cayó luego a la luz blanquísima de la luna sobre la terraza del palacio. A lo lejos el Popocatepetl y el Ixtacihuatl irradiaban sus testas de nieve blanquísima en la tenebrosidad azul de los horizontes.	The immense silence of night fell, bathed in the moon's purest light upon the terrace of the palace. In the distance, Popocatepetl and Ixtacihuatl shone, their heads crowned with purest white snow in the dark blue of the horizon.	Night's deep silence fell as the moon's radiant light bathed the palace terrace. In the distance, Popocatepetl and Ixtacihuatl gleamed, their snowy crowns glowing against the dark blue horizon.	Eternal snow-capped peaks symbolize immortal lovers watching over the land.	Smoothed poetic description into natural English.
84	Y dijo el rey a sus guardias: "Dejad morir de hambre el viejo Zapoteca!"	And the king said to his guards: "Let the old Zapotec die of hunger!"	And the king ordered his guards: "Let the old Zapotec die of hunger!"	Tragic historical note — symbolic rejection of indigenous wisdom (Zapotec priest).	Clarified harsh royal command with natural phrasing.